SkillNavora · Business AI Stack

COMPLETE GUIDE 06 OF 15

Lovable Apps

A practical guide with steps, examples and a checklist. Read the chapter, then build the example.

BUILD APPS · COMPLETE GUIDE

Lovable: build a full-stack app from a conversation

Lovable turns a description into a working web app: screens, a database and sign-in, with the code visible and synced to GitHub. This guide builds a job-application tracker, a real app you can use every day, and shows where it stops and you start.

1. What Lovable is, and is not

- **Good for:** dashboards, forms, internal tools, landing pages, simple marketplaces, MVPs you can test with real users.
- **Not a replacement for:** security review, payments design, large data processing, or complex business logic without a developer.
- **You still own the code.** Lovable can sync the project to GitHub; keep that repository so you can move it later.

2. Write the spec first (one page)

Part	Job Tracker example
Users	One job seeker (you), later invited friends
Data	Applications: company, role, link, status, date applied, follow-up date, notes
Screens	Sign in; Board (columns by status); Application form; Reminders
Rules	Only the owner sees their applications; a follow-up is due 7 days after applying

3. Build it in six prompts

1. **Prompt 1 (scaffold):** *"Build a job application tracker. Sign-in with email. A board with columns: Saved, Applied, Interview, Offer, Rejected. Each card shows company, role and follow-up date."*
2. **Prompt 2 (data):** *"Connect Supabase. Create the table applications with the fields above, and row level security so each user sees only their own rows."* Check the policy in Supabase; ask the agent to show you the SQL.
3. **Prompt 3 (form):** *"Add an application form with validation: company and role are required; the link must start with https; follow-up defaults to 7 days after applied date."*
4. **Prompt 4 (drag and drop):** *"Let me drag a card between columns and save the new status."*
5. **Prompt 5 (reminders):** *"Show a Reminders panel listing applications whose follow-up date is today or earlier."*
6. **Prompt 6 (publish):** Click Publish, then test on your phone. Invite one friend and confirm they cannot see your rows.

4. Test like a real user

- Create two accounts. Check that account A cannot read account B's rows, by trying the URL and the API.
- Try invalid input: an empty company name, a link without https.
- Refresh during a drag: the status should be saved, not lost.
- Check the layout at 390 pixels wide.

5. Add an AI step (optional, carefully)

Ask for a button "Summarise job description" that sends the pasted text to a model and stores a three-bullet summary. Keep the key on the server (an Edge Function or the Supabase function), never in the browser. Limit usage per user to control cost.

SECURITY BEFORE LAUNCH

Turn on email confirmation and password rules in Supabase Auth. Make sure every table has row level security. Never paste a service-role key into a prompt or into the front end.

6. When to bring in a developer

- Payments, personal data at scale, or medical and financial records.

- Background jobs, email sending at volume, or custom APIs.
- Any time you need a code review before launch.

7. Checklist

- Spec on one page before prompting.
- Row level security checked with two accounts.
- Validation tested; mobile layout checked.
- Code synced to GitHub; keys stored in Supabase or Lovable secrets, not in code.

Lovable's features, plans and integration steps change often. Check its current documentation and Supabase's Auth and row-level-security docs before you publish.